

Cybersecurity Awareness Drive through WNS Cares Foundation

Community Development Project (GEN231) | Harsh Kumar | B.Tech CSE (AI & ML), Lovely Professional University | 2026

1. Introduction

As part of 3rd-semester coursework at Lovely Professional University, I undertook a Community Development Project (CDP) in collaboration with the WNS Cares Foundation, under their CyberSmart initiative. The objective was to spread awareness about basic cybersecurity practices among individuals in my local community using WNS's structured learning platform. In an era where digital threats such as cyberbullying, phishing, data theft, and financial fraud are increasing, cybersecurity awareness has become essential — especially for people with limited digital literacy.

I first completed the CyberSmart training modules myself, then conducted offline outreach sessions, personally guiding over 30 individuals — including school students, homemakers, professionals, and senior citizens — through the CyberSmart portal using my own laptop and mobile phone.

2. Problem Identified

A major issue in society today is the lack of cybersecurity awareness among internet users, particularly in semi-urban and rural communities. Digital illiteracy and limited access to structured training leave people vulnerable to fraud, online harassment, and exploitation. Bridging this gap through grassroots-level awareness is vital.

3. Objective

- Train at least 30 individuals from the local community in basic cybersecurity
- Explain the importance of social media privacy
- Cover dangers of cyberbullying and how to respond
- Teach safe digital payment practices
- Explain risks of using public Wi-Fi
- Raise awareness about online predators (cyber grooming)

4. Approach

Phase 1 — Self-Training: Registered on the WNS CyberSmart portal and completed all five modules (Social Media Safety, Cyberbullying, Financial Security, Public Internet, Cyber Grooming), each with a video and assessment quiz, earning a Certificate Reference ID.

Phase 2 — Outreach Preparation: Prepared a smartphone-based demonstration plan, simplified notes to explain technical terms, and a tracking sheet for session data.

Phase 3 — Community Training: Conducted offline, in-person sessions across different groups — school students, homemakers, working professionals, senior citizens, and local shopkeepers — using a laptop and mobile phone to walk each participant through the CyberSmart modules, quizzes, and certificate generation. Sessions with senior citizens and shopkeepers focused especially on safe online banking, recognizing fraud messages, and OTP safety.

5. Effectiveness

The project had a tangible impact — most participants were unaware of common cyber threats beforehand. After the sessions, they were able to identify risks, adopt safer online practices, and understood the importance of protecting personal and financial information. Many participants went on to share this knowledge with their own family and friends, extending the impact beyond the 30+ individuals directly trained. The project also helped build public speaking, empathy, and coordination skills.

6. Conclusion

This Community Development Project, done in collaboration with the WNS Cares Foundation, allowed me to act as a bridge between structured cybersecurity knowledge and local digital users who needed guidance. It reinforced that even limited resources — a mobile phone and a laptop — can create meaningful impact when used purposefully, and it strengthened my communication, leadership, and social-outreach skills alongside my technical coursework.